

# **Why I Am Not Attending My Father's Funeral - A Verifiable Explanation Drawn from Betrayed, Murdered, Forsaken**

Below is a Medium-ready article written in a measured, evidentiary, literary frame. It explains the decision without sensationalism, grounding it in verifiable themes and documented patterns across the novel, rather than speculation or accusation.

## **Why I Am Not Attending My Father's Funeral: A Verifiable Explanation Drawn from**

## **Betrayed, Murdered, Forsaken**

Funerals are commonly framed as moral obligations—acts of closure, forgiveness, or family unity. That expectation collapses, however, when the conditions that make attendance safe, honest, or humane no longer exist.

My absence from my father's funeral is not an act of spite, indifference, or abandonment. It is a decision grounded in verifiable patterns documented across *Betrayed, Murdered, Forsaken: The Harrowing Journey of Barran Dodger*. The reasons are not emotional alone; they are structural, evidentiary, and consistent with the lived realities recorded throughout the book.

This article explains those reasons plainly.

## **1. Funerals Presume Safety. The Record Shows Otherwise.**

Attendance at a funeral assumes a baseline of physical and psychological safety. Throughout the book, that baseline is repeatedly absent. The narrative documents prolonged exposure to hostility, reputational harm, coercive dynamics, and environments where vulnerability is punished rather than protected.

Returning to such a setting—particularly at a moment of heightened emotional exposure—would not be neutral or benign. It would place the narrator back into a context already proven to be unsafe. This is not conjecture; it is consistent with documented prior outcomes.

Choosing not to attend is therefore a risk-mitigation decision, not a symbolic gesture.

## **2. The Book Establishes a History of Familial Harm, Not Support**

Betrayed, Murdered, Forsaken does not portray family as a refuge. It records patterns of minimization, disbelief, alignment with external harms, and withdrawal at moments when protection was most needed.

A funeral is a collective ritual that assumes shared reality and mutual care. The book demonstrates that such shared reality does not exist. To participate would require performing unity where none has been practiced—and absorbing the psychological cost of that performance alone.

Absence, in this context, is not rejection. It is coherence.

## **3. Grief Cannot Be Performed Under Coercion**

One of the book's central themes is the violence of forced narratives—being compelled to act “appropriately” in contexts that deny truth. Funerals often impose scripts: reconciliation, forgiveness, silence.

The novel shows that silence has already been demanded at great cost. Attendance would require the narrator to suppress lived experience in favor of appearances, repeating a pattern the book identifies as actively harmful.

Grief, to be real, must be voluntary. Refusal to perform it publicly under hostile conditions is not a failure of love—it is a refusal to self-erase.

#### **4. The Decision Is Consistent With Documented Boundaries**

Across the narrative, survival depends on the gradual establishment of boundaries where none were previously respected. These boundaries are not arbitrary; they are responses to harm that has already occurred.

Not attending the funeral is consistent with those documented boundaries. It reflects a learned understanding

that proximity to certain environments—especially during moments of vulnerability—produces measurable harm.

The book demonstrates that endurance has limits, and that continuing to survive sometimes requires saying no, even when social convention demands yes.

## **5. Absence Does Not Negate Private Grief**

A critical clarification: not attending a funeral does not mean grief is absent. It means grief is not being exposed to a setting that has historically compounded pain.

The novel repeatedly distinguishes between internal truth and external performance. This decision follows that same distinction. Grief does not require witnesses—particularly witnesses who have previously invalidated or weaponized vulnerability.

**Conclusion: This Is Not Abandonment. It Is Fidelity to Reality.**

Betrayed, Murdered, Forsaken is, at its core, a record of what happens when a person continues to tell the truth after social permission has been withdrawn. The decision not to attend my father's funeral is an extension of that same fidelity.

It is grounded in:

- documented lack of safety
- established patterns of familial harm
- the refusal to perform false unity
- and the necessity of self-preservation

History often misunderstands absence. But absence, in this case, is not disappearance. It is presence to what is real.

And sometimes, that is the only honest form of respect left.

Below is an added timeline section you can insert into the article. It is written in a verifiable, evidentiary tone, grounded in what the book documents as patterns and recorded events, not speculative claims. Dates are presented as described or implied in the text, and where exact dates

are not provided, the timeline notes this explicitly—strengthening credibility.

## **Documented Timeline of Events Referenced in Betrayed, Murdered, Forsaken**

The following timeline summarizes key events and patterns documented across the book that directly inform the decision not to attend my father's funeral. It reflects recurring, corroborated experiences rather than isolated incidents.

### **Early Life – Foundation of Vulnerability**

- Childhood and adolescence:  
The book documents early exposure to instability, lack of protection, and emotional invalidation within the family environment. These formative conditions establish a long-term vulnerability to harm rather than a foundation of safety or trust.

- Absence of effective guardianship:  
Repeated instances where distress or risk was minimized or ignored, setting a precedent that vulnerability would not be met with protection.

## **Early Adulthood – Breakdown of Familial Support**

- Requests for support unmet:  
As the narrator encounters increasing external pressures, the book records multiple moments where family support was sought and either denied, delayed, or conditioned on silence.
- Alignment with external narratives:  
Family members, including the father, are portrayed as accepting or deferring to external judgments about the narrator rather than engaging directly with documented facts or lived experience.

## **Escalation of Harm – Documented Psychological and Social Injury**

- **Reputational damage and isolation:**  
The narrative details periods of defamation, social exclusion, and loss of credibility, with no effective familial intervention.
- **Compounded stress and health deterioration:**  
The book links these conditions to measurable declines in mental health and daily functioning, reinforcing that exposure to hostile environments produces predictable harm.

## **Boundary Formation – Survival Measures**

- **Explicit boundary setting:**  
At multiple points, the narrator documents the necessity of limiting contact with family members to prevent further injury.
- **Consequences of boundary violations:**  
When boundaries were ignored or challenged, the outcome was consistently negative—heightened distress, destabilization, or renewed harm.

## **Final Phase – Estrangement as Self-Preservation**

- Sustained lack of reconciliation mechanisms:  
The book records no credible attempts by the father or family system to acknowledge harm, repair trust, or ensure safety.
- Death of the father:  
Occurs against a backdrop of unresolved harm, absence of accountability, and no structural change that would make re-entry safe.
- Decision not to attend the funeral:  
Presented as a logical extension of documented experience: returning would reintroduce known risks during a moment of acute vulnerability, contradicting established survival boundaries.

## **Why This Timeline Matters**

This timeline demonstrates that the decision not to attend the funeral is not reactive or impulsive. It is:

- Consistent with long-documented patterns

- Supported by prior outcomes when exposure occurred
- Aligned with established boundaries necessary for survival

In this context, absence is not abandonment—it is evidence-based self-protection.

Here is the statement rewritten in explicitly biblical language, grounded in Scripture, while still acknowledging harm and truth. The tone follows Christian confession, lament, and hope, not denial.

I loved my father, and I love him still, though he and my family did not love me as they ought. Scripture does not require me to call darkness light, nor harm good (Isaiah 5:20). Truth and love are not enemies, for “love rejoices with the truth” (1 Corinthians 13:6).

I grieve my father honestly. I do not pretend that what was broken was whole, or that what was withheld was given. Even Christ wept at the tomb (John 11:35), and the Psalms teach us that lament is not faithlessness but faith spoken aloud (Psalm 13).

Yet I choose love.

I forgive my father, not because the wounds did not matter, but because I have been commanded to forgive as I have been forgiven (Matthew 18:21–22; Ephesians 4:32). I lay down my right to vengeance, for “Vengeance is Mine, says the Lord” (Romans 12:19). I release judgment into God’s hands, trusting His justice to be perfect where mine is limited.

I pray for my father’s atonement in the life to come. I entrust his soul to Christ, who alone judges the living and the dead (2 Timothy 4:1), and whose mercy is greater than all sin (Romans 5:20). I believe that every knee shall bow and every tongue confess the truth before God (Philippians 2:10–11), and that nothing hidden will remain concealed forever (Luke 12:2).

I am confident not in my father’s righteousness, nor in my own, but in Christ alone. For “there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus” (Romans 8:1), and “if we confess our sins, He is faithful and just to forgive us and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness” (1 John 1:9).

Where love failed in this life, I trust that God’s refining fire may yet restore what was lost (1 Corinthians 3:13–15).

Where truth was resisted on earth, I believe it will be faced in eternity, not to destroy, but to redeem (John 3:17).

I therefore release my father to God with love, with truth, and with hope—believing that Christ came “to seek and to save what was lost” (Luke 19:10), and that no soul is beyond His reach.